

TIM BOETTIGER

GEM BOX

PROJECT STARGEM
TWINKLE

INSTRUCTION BOOKLET

Thank you for playing TWINKLE - the free version of PROJECT STARGEM. I've loved match-3 games since I was a kid, and three years ago I started building the game I always wanted to play on my favorite handheld.

I want everyone who feels like playing a good match-3 game to be able to just play one for free, just like I did with so many other great games.

I truly hope you love playing it as much as I loved creating it.



Before you start playing, please read this booklet carefully and be sure to follow the correct operating procedures. Keep this instruction booklet safe for future reference.

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CAUTIONS DURING USE

1. If you play for long periods, take a 10- to 15-minute break every hour or so.
2. This Game Pak is precision-built. Do not use or store it under conditions of extreme temperature, or subject it to rough handling or shock. Do not disassemble the unit.
3. Do not touch the terminals or let them come into contact with water, as this can cause malfunction.
4. Don't wipe this Game Pak with volatile solvents such as thinner, benzene, or alcohol.
5. Store the Game Pak in its protective case when not in use.

WHAT IS PROJECT STARGEM: TWINKLE?

PROJECT STARGEM: TWINKLE is a match-3 puzzle game. Swap neighbouring Gems to line up three or more of the same colour. Matching Gems disappear, new ones fall into place, and chain reactions can send your highscore soaring.

Create Special Gems and combine them to unleash spectacular chain reactions, as gravity pulls fresh Gems into cascading follow-up matches. A single, perfectly timed move can set off an avalanche of points and send your energy to new heights!

This edition of PROJECT STARGEM is made to be picked up and played whenever you feel like matching some Gems. No long dialogue, no waiting around, just quick and easy fun.

And maybe you'll end up loving it as much as I do and give its "mother" game, PROJECT STARGEM, a shot. It shares the same game mechanics, but adds different game modes, multiplayer sessions, printer support and a few other surprises!

Supported Hardware Extensions

PROJECT STARGEM: TWINKLE supports the following Game Boy hardware extensions:

RUMBLE

LINK CABLE

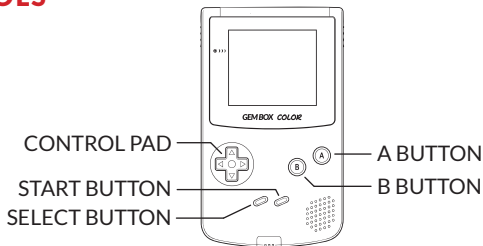
PRINTER

INFRARED

SAVE GAMES

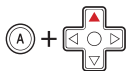
1. USING THE CONTROLS

Names and Functions of Parts

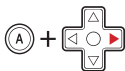


How to use the Controls

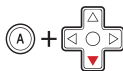
1. Use the  **Control Pad** to move the cursor.
2. To pick the Gem you want to swap, lock it by pressing **A**.
3. To cancel (and *unlock* the Gem), press **B**.
4. To swap the Gem and complete your move, press the  **Control Pad** in the direction of the Gem you want to swap it with:



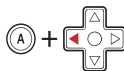
Swap with
the upper Gem



Swap with
the right Gem



Swap with
the lower Gem



Swap with
the left Gem

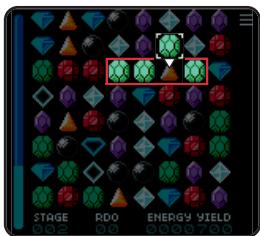
2. HOW TO PLAY

This game offers the beloved original Match-3 gameplay using these rules:

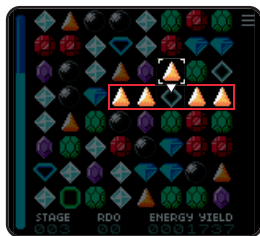
1. Only swap the locked Gem with an **orthogonally adjacent** Gem.
2. A successful swap must create a match of **at least 3 Gems** of the same type.
3. You can only match Gems of the **same colour** (including Power Gems). Exceptions are Hypercubes and (if enabled) Joker Stargems.
4. The game ends when **no more matches** are possible.
5. TWINKLE supports **autosave**. You can quit the game or shut off your handheld at any time and continue right where you left off.



MATCH-3 EXAMPLE



MATCH-4 EXAMPLE



MATCH-5 EXAMPLE

General Tips

1. Before you clear a match, always check whether you could form a Hypercube, or Power Gem instead.
2. If you're running low on moves, trigger a Power Gem or start a chain to clear a large area. Gravity will often open up new options afterward.
3. Save one or more Hypercubes until no other move is left. Then use a Hypercube on the most common colour on the board.
4. Keep your Hypercubes away from Power Gems, Stargems, and Bombs, since any explosion can destroy these precious Special Gems.
5. Force the creation of Special Gems in the upper board area by creating smaller matches below that bring the required Gems into the desired pattern.

Pro Tips

After mastering the general tips, it is time to work on your efficiency:

1. You can trigger the most matches, the largest chains, and the longest cascades by making a match in the lower middle of the board.
2. Avoid triggering Power Gems along the edge of the board, as part of their explosion area will be wasted.
3. If you plan to make several available swaps, start with the upper ones: When you choose a lower swap instead, gravity may destroy the upper opportunities.
4. For the most effective explosions, place Power Gems at the edge of a match group. If they're in the middle, part of the explosion will hit empty spaces.

Common Gems

No Gem matching without Gems! There are 7 different base Gems. They differ in shape and colour to help you identify them in the blink of an eye:



Diamond



Emerald



Amethyst



Ruby



Onyx-Pearl



Citrine



Aquamarine

Create Power Gems

When you combine **4 or more** Common Gems of the same colour, they vanish, and a Power Gem appears in their place. Power Gems are highly unstable.



If you combine them in a match with other Gems of the same colour, they'll explode in a 3x3 area!



Create Hypercubes

Combine five identical Gems **in a row** to create a mighty Hypercube: swap it with any Gem, and it draws in and clears every Gem of that colour before it vanishes.



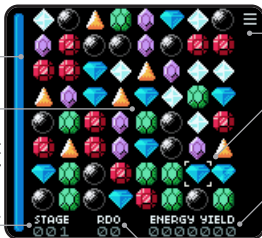
Warning: The Hypercube is destroyed by any explosion!

The Board

Progress Bar: Shows progress or countdown

Board: An 8×8 board with up to 64 gems on it.

Stage: Your current level. The progress bar shows how long until the next level.



Menu: Unfolds below.

Cursor: The cursor to lock Gems and execute gem swaps.

Energy Yield: The total energy earned in the current game.

RDO (Read-Out): Displays various information depending on the situation.

In-Game Menu

Accessible in-game by pressing **START**. This also pauses the game.

Close the menu by pressing the **START** button again.

Choose an option with the **Control Pad** by pressing up or down, then select it with **A**.



Preferences

Request Hint

Quit Game and return to the Title Screen

3. OTHER FUNCTIONS

Preferences

You can access Preferences from within the game by pressing **SELECT** or from the in-game menu selecting the Preferences icon (see page 7).

Use the **Control Pad** to move between settings. The one highlighted in red is your current selection. Press **A** to toggle settings, **START** to save and **B** to cancel (*return to the running game without saving*).



PREFERENCES SCREEN

Visual Settings

The first options help you to **customise audiovisual effects**: You can slow down or speed up movements, and disable screen shaking or flashing effects if you are sensitive to them.

Audio

If you don't want to disturb anyone or don't like music during gameplay, mute music or sound effects.

Assistance

New to the game (*or just here to relax*)? Enable Autohint.

Hardware

Rumble-based haptic feedback is supported by some mobile emulators, handhelds, and FPGA cores, and of course by the original cartridge (see next page).

Hint System

Stuck on your next move? The hint system is fast, smart, and always a good call. But each hint *costs you 75 Energy Yield*, so you'll need enough points on the board to use it. Press **START** to open the menu, select the «?» symbol and press **A**.

The cursor moves to the best available move and an arrow indicates the swap direction. Press **A** as usual to make the suggested swap.

Prefer hands-off help? Switch on Autohint in the settings: if you hesitate too long, it nudges the cursor to the best move for you (and it's completely free).

Rumble

Perhaps you're one of the lucky few who own a flashable **cartridge with onboard rumble**! If not, it's worth checking which handheld or emulator you're playing on.

- Some emulators (especially on smartphones: Same Boy) and handhelds (such as the Game Bub) can use the device's **built-in vibration motor**.
- And if you're playing the ROM on a cartridge-capable FPGA gaming device (such as ModRetro Chromatic or Analogue Pocket), you may be able to install and use an **FPGA core that supports rumble** for ROMs. These cores delegate the rumble signal to an inserted rumble cartridge (such as a DS Rumble Pak or clone).

Scan the code
for more tips on the
rumble feature



4. ABOUT SCORING

Your score is measured in energy. **You earn energy for every match** you make. A match consists of **three or more Gems** of the same type aligned in a row or column.

When **Special Gems** explode, they give you energy, clear a larger area, and **trigger nearby Special Gems**. When one Special Gem activates another, it creates a chain.

Since Special Gems clear more Gems than normal matches, they also cause more new Gems to fall onto the board. The more Gems that spawn, the greater the chance of **creating additional matches** automatically. This is called a **cascade**.

Energy Yield Base Score

1. First, you earn 10 energy for every Gem beyond the second:

Group	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
Energy	10	20	30	40	50	60	70

2. **Special Gems** that are part of the match: an additional **25 energy each**.
3. When a Special Gem goes off, it is scored separately from the Gems it destroys: 40 energy, plus 10 energy for every Special Gem triggered during this move.

Special Gem	1 st	2 nd	3 rd	4 th	5 th	6 th	7 th
Energy	40	50	60	70	80	90	100

4. A **Hypercube** awards **energy for each Gem** it removes from the board: 20 energy per Common Gem and 60 energy per Special Gem.

Cascade Bonus

At the beginning of each cascade, you'll earn 10 energy per cascade level:

Cascade	0	1	2	3	4	5	6
Energy	-	10	20	30	40	50	60

Level Multiplier

The base value is then multiplied by your current level. Level 1 (the base) is $\times 1.0$ and each subsequent level increases the multiplier by 0.5 :

Level	1	2	5	10	15	20	25
Multiplier	1.0	1.5	3	5.5	8	10.5	13

Example

You are at level 3. Your move clears a group of five Gems that happens to contain one Power Gem, and it is the second cascade of the move:

1. 5 Gems: $(5 - 2) \times 10$	30
2. 1 Power Gem in the group: 25	+ 25
3. 2nd cascade: 2×10	+ 20
4. The Power Gem explodes: 40	+ 40
5. Subtotal	= 115
6. Level 3 multiplier	$\times 2.0$
7. Total	= 230

5. VARIOUS INFORMATION

Display Technical Game Information

Support may ask you to provide information about your game edition or version.

To display this information, open the Preferences screen (see page 8), then *press and hold SELECT* for *at least 30 seconds*.

Special Thanks

Thank you, Thorsten Ruf, for spending countless hours testing every detail of the game, for your enthusiasm, and for believing in me and in the project as a whole from day one.

WARNING - REPETITIVE MOTION AND DISCOMFORT

Extended gaming sessions and repeated movements may cause temporary discomfort or strain in the hands, wrists, arms, joints, muscles, or skin.

To reduce the risk of discomfort, take regular breaks and avoid playing continuously for long periods. If you experience fatigue, pain, numbness, tingling, stiffness, or other discomfort while playing, stop playing and allow your body to recover.

If symptoms continue, return frequently, or become more severe, discontinue play and seek advice from a qualified medical professional.

WARNING - PHOTSENSITIVE SEIZURES

Flashing lights, rapidly changing images, or visual patterns may cause seizures or other adverse reactions in some people, even without a previous history of epilepsy.

Stop playing immediately and seek medical advice if you experience:

- Seizures or convulsions
- Loss of awareness or consciousness
- Eye or muscle twitching
- Altered or blurred vision
- Dizziness or disorientation
- Involuntary movements

If you or a family member has a history of epilepsy or seizures, consult a medical professional before playing.

TO REDUCE THE RISK:

Play in a well-lit room, maintain a comfortable distance from the screen, avoid playing when tired, and take regular breaks. Slow down animations in the settings (see page 8). Stop playing immediately if you begin to feel unwell or experience unusual symptoms.



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<https://timboettiger.itch.io/project-stargem-twinkle>